



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Alachua Learning Academy
School Website: <https://ourala.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Alachua Learning Academy (ALA) presents as a tuition-free public charter K–8 school with a clearly stated emphasis on a nurturing, values-based, character-formation approach within a small-school setting. Public materials emphasize virtues via the school's H.E.A.R.T. framework, a family-oriented environment, personalized, hands-on programs, and strong academic performance. However, the site does not explicitly articulate the classical-tradition markers most central to traditional Classical Education (e.g., liberal-arts curriculum built on the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, and liturgical or theological formation). Public materials describe advanced coursework and experiential programs, but there is limited explicit reference to the canonical Great Books tradition, direct Socratic seminars in upper grades, or a history-centered, literature-rich curriculum typical of a fully Classical program.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Strengths aligned with Classical sensibilities in formation, virtue, and a focus on humane education (moral character, lifelong learning; values-based life). Evidence: statements about character formation and the small-family environment, plus a family-centered approach and emphasis on virtues (H.E.A.R.T.). - Evidence of classical curriculum and pedagogy is present but not explicit or comprehensive (no clear Great Books emphasis, no explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, few direct references to Scholé or Socratic seminars in the public materials). Evidence of curriculum includes core subjects, hands-on and experiential learning, and a program like ACCEL, but not the classical lexicon. - Religious/metaphysical foundations are not present; the school states it is nonsectarian. This challenges the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations criteria in the classical rubric, though it aligns with some secular approaches to classical education. - Parent and community engagement is present (families reported as valuing the school, and there are enrollment options and family involvement themes), but explicit “co-teacher” partnership language is less obvious in public materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly states it is not a religious school and is non-sectarian. This is direct guidance from public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keyword hits: 0 (no direct usage of classical religious/metaphysical terms like theology, liturgy, sacred, etc., in the public materials).
- Negative keyword hits: 0 (no explicit signaling of relativism or secular humanism as a downside in the materials).
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit theological grounding, liturgical practice, or transcendent metaphysical language in public-facing materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category under the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Emphasizes formation of moral character and lifelong learning within a small-family environment; mentions values-based approach and leadership orientation. Example language: “we focus on development of moral character and adventurous exploration,” and “we believe that every child is a leader,” with an emphasis on lifelong learning.
- The school frames education as formation and character development rather than narrow information transfer, aligning with some classical aims (formation, virtue, human flourishing) even if not using the exact classical vocabulary.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive hits: 3 (formation of virtue/character; lifelong learning; values-based approach) — in effect, articulation of formation and virtue.
- Negative hits: 0 (no explicit modern workforce- or college-readiness framing here; the emphasis is on formation and virtue rather than job-training language).
- Why this rating
- The school clearly foregrounds formation, virtue, and human flourishing as aims, which maps to the classical ideal of education as the cultivation of virtue and wisdom. However, there is less explicit articulation of the transcendental truths or the precise classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty) in public messaging, and no explicit Great Conversation framing. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials list core subjects (Language Arts, Math, Science, STEM, Art, PE) and an ACCEL program with courses like Seven Habits for Highly Effective People, Spanish, Publishing, Creative Writing, Digital Media, Speech. This reflects a robust, modern, hands-on curriculum rather than a classical liberal-arts curriculum centered on grammar-logic-rhetoric, and Great Books.
- No explicit reference to Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, or a classical history-literature emphasis across the curriculum. The content emphasizes applied and experiential learning rather than the traditional classical core.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive hits: 2 (core subjects; hands-on/experiential learning; ACCEL program with enrichment subjects).
- Negative hits: 0 (no explicit Great Books, no explicit Trivium/Quadrivium, no explicit classical history approach; not stated as history-centric as a traditional classical school).
- Why this rating
- While robust in its own right, the curriculum described does not meet the explicit Classical Curriculum criteria (Great Books, liberal arts–centered Trivium, Great Conversation). It aligns more with a modern, experiential, and broad-core-curriculum approach. Hence NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize hands-on, experiential learning and small-class advantages; however, explicit classical pedagogy elements such as Socratic seminars in upper grades, graded liberal-arts pedagogy, or Scholé/restful learning as a daily practice are not clearly documented in the public-facing content. The site highlights a program with academic excellence and project-like experiences but not explicit classical pedagogy names.
- There is no explicit reference to Socratic dialogue, classical memorization methods, chanting, or the liturgical/recitation practices extensively described in classical pedagogy lexicons.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive hits: 1–2 (hands-on/experiential learning; structured programs such as ACCEL) — but not the classical pedagogy terminology itself.
- Negative hits: 0–1 (no explicit inclusion of Socratic seminars or scholé language in public content; lack of stated restful/scholé pedagogy).
- Why this rating

- The visible pedagogy emphasizes experiential and hands-on learning rather than explicitly classical methods (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization through chant, etc.). Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site describes caring, small-staff teacher teams and a nurturing environment; language like “small family environment,” “caring teachers,” and the notion of teachers as mentors in a values-based setting appears. This aligns with the classical notion of a living curriculum and teachers as exemplary role models, though not spelled out in formal classical-language terms.
- The materials emphasize virtue and character formation as part of the teacher’s role and a mentorship tone. The explicit “living curriculum” phrasing is not common in the public materials; still, there are indicators of teacher-model and mentorship culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive hits: 2–3 (mentorship/teachers as living curriculum-like tone; small-school faculty; character formation emphasis).
- Negative hits: 0 (no explicit portrait of what a teacher should be in classical terms; no formal classical faculty-profiles section).
- Why this rating
- The presence of a values-based, mentor-style teacher culture suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment, though the classical lexicon (e.g., “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum” as formal ray) is not overtly used in public materials. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes a family orientation, small-school environment, and parental engagement through positive quotes from parents about the school, plus enrollment via lottery; this suggests partnership with families and a hospitable community tone. The materials also highlight “happy families” and a values-based environment.
- Documentation of family involvement, visits, and a welcoming environment is present, though explicit “co-teachers” language and formal parent-formation activities (book studies, nightly family liturgies, etc.) are not clearly spelled out in public-facing content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive hits: 2–3 (family environment, parental engagement themes, lottery-based enrollment; “open” access to information and visits are implied).
- Negative hits: 0–1 (no explicit “parents as co-teachers” or formal parent-formation programs described in public content).
- Why this rating
- There is meaningful parental involvement and community warmth, but the public content does not lay out a formal traditional “parents as co-teachers” framework typical of classic models. This supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Based on keyword signals and explicit statements in the six categories, the school exhibits partial alignment with classical education (formation, virtue, small community). However, it does not consistently demonstrate core Classical Education hallmarks (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Scholé pedagogy, liturgical/theological foundations, explicit classical teacher portraits). Therefore, the aggregate rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly articulate a Great Books/Great Conversation component within the curriculum and clearly connect it to a liberal-arts framework (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric progression) across K–8 with planned teacher-led seminars.

- Introduce formal Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades (Socratic seminars, dialectic discussions) and a clear pathway from K–8 that transitions to a high-school classical program.
- Adopt explicit Scholé/restful-learning practices as a daily or weekly rhythm (quiet study, contemplative reading periods, and structured memory work) with documentation in the curriculum guide.
- Develop a formal “Living Curriculum” portrait of the teacher and a “portrait of a student” aligned with classical ideals, including ongoing teacher training in classical pedagogy (logical reasoning, classical rhetoric, and memorization).
- Expand the curriculum to include the liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) along with a study of Western civilization/history from a classical perspective and the canon of classical authors (with opportunities for Latin/Greek exposure as appropriate).
- Strengthen explicit religious or metaphysical foundations (if chosen) in a nonsectarian way (e.g., a shared language around truth, goodness, beauty that respects pluralism) or, if remaining nonsectarian, explicitly articulate how classical aims can be pursued within a pluralistic framework without theological instruction.
- Increase explicit parent-education programming that positions parents as co-teachers and aligns family life with classical formation (reading groups, seminars, family liturgies if aligned with the school’s values).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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